
ANI

SUYASH SHARMA, 21

***Leg-spinner*, Royal Challengers Bengaluru**

His hairstyle was compared Neeraj Chopra's when he burst on to the scene in the 2023 IPL season. Suyash, who comes from Bhajanpura in Delhi, also grabbed some meme attention with his unusual style of looking up when delivering the ball. Despite a good debut season, Kolkata Knight Riders did not use him much in 2024 and Royal Challengers Bengaluru picked him up after some hectic bidding for the 2025 season. The Chinnaswamy Stadium has a great relationship with leg-spinners. Just ask Yuzvendra Chahal, who was RCB's leading wicket-taker in IPL till he moved on. Will Suyash spin a similar web this year?


AFP

JOSH INGLIS, 30

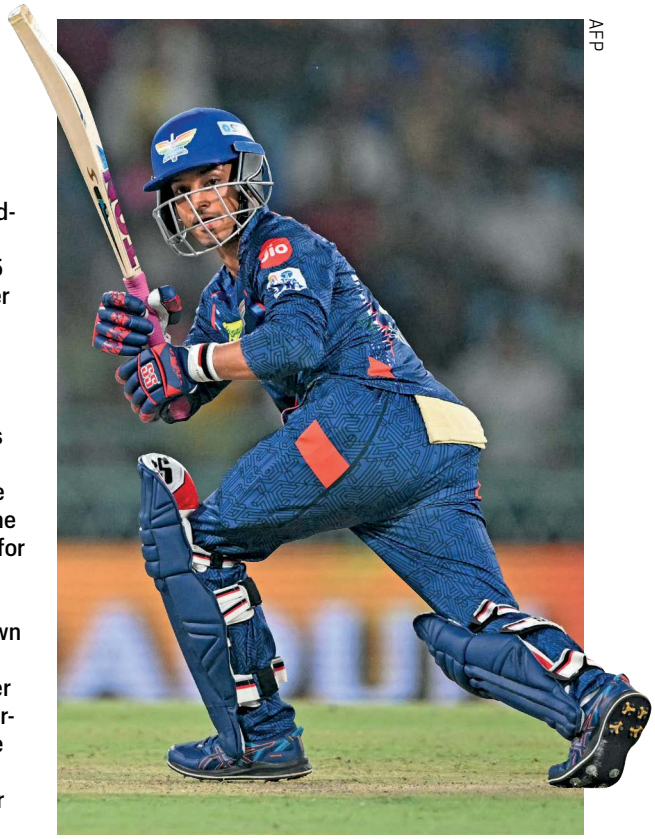
***Wicketkeeper batsman*, Punjab Kings**

Steady in the middle overs and power hitting in the death, Inglis offers the complete deal. The Australian's hitting prowess was on show in Lahore in the Champions Trophy, and who can forget his calm knock against South Africa in the 2023 World Cup semi-final in Kolkata? Inglis, who made his debut in 2022, already has hundreds in all three formats. Making his IPL debut, the wicketkeeper-bat will be key for the Punjab Kings.

AYUSH BADONI, 25

***Batter*, Lucknow Super Giants**

Badoni first hit the headlines when he hit 19 sixes in a knock of 165 off 55 balls in a Delhi Premier League match in 2024. The big-hitting reputation has been burnished by his Ranji trophy outings, so much so he's already being touted as leadership material for his side, Delhi. By the end of the 2024 Ranji Trophy season, he was also the top run-getter for his side. In his IPL side, Lucknow Super Giants, Badoni has been shifted up and down the order, with most of his impact knocks coming lower down the order. With an average of nearly 30 and a strike rate of close to 140, Badoni might just steal the show for the Super Giants this IPL.


AFP

RAMANDEEP SINGH, 27

***All-rounder*, Kolkata Knight Riders**

Gun fielder. Aggressive lower-order bat. If one needed a definition for utility, Ramandeep Singh ticks all the boxes. Hailing from Chandigarh, Ramandeep's rise in Indian cricket has been rapid, backed by a fantastic IPL 2024 to boost the Kolkata Knight Riders title charge. Apart from the IPL, Ramandeep also had a decent Emerging Asia Cup, the highlight being 64 off 34 balls versus Afghanistan. The race for the next big all-rounder after Hardik Pandya is heating up, with Nitish Reddy too in the picture.

